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General Knowledge

Indian Polity

STUDY NOTES

Political Parties in India

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Political Parties in India

Introduction

- **Definition:** Political parties are organized groups of people who share similar political ideologies and work towards gaining power in government through elections.
- **Purpose:** Their primary aim is to organize public opinion, contest elections, and influence policies to serve national interests.
- **Political Spectrum:** Political parties can be categorized on a left-right spectrum, with left-wing parties seeking radical changes (e.g., CPI, CPM), centrist parties like Congress, and right-wing parties advocating for traditional values (e.g., BJP).
- **Party Systems:** Political parties operate in different types of party systems:
    - **One-Party System:** No opposition (e.g., Soviet Union).
    - **Two-Party System:** Two dominant parties (e.g., United States).
    - **Multi-Party System:** Many parties coexist, often forming coalitions (e.g., India).
- **Significance:** Political parties form the backbone of representative democracies, ensuring governance and accountability.

Detailed Study of Political Parties in India

- **Historical Background**

- **Pre-Independence Era:** Indian politics was initially dominated by the Congress Party, and the political landscape was more centered around British interests.
- **Post-Independence:** After independence, the Congress Party led by Jawaharlal Nehru dominated Indian politics from 1952 to 1964, known as the "Congress System."
- **Decline of Congress Monopoly:** Following Nehru's death in 1964 and the 1967 elections, regional parties began emerging, challenging Congress's hold.
- **Coalition Era:** By 1977, the Janata Party was formed as a coalition, marking the beginning of a multi-party system in India, which continued post-1989.

Types of Political Parties in India

- **National Parties:** Recognized by the Election Commission for significant national influence.
- **List of National Parties (until 2024)**
  1. Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP)
  2. Indian National Congress (INC)
  3. Communist Party of India (Marxist)
  4. Bahujan Samaj Party(BSP)
  5. Aam Aadmi Party(AAP)
  6. National People's Party
- **State Parties:** Have recognition in specific states based on election performance.
  - **Examples**: Trinamool Congress (TMC), Nationalist Congress Party (NCP), Bahujan Samaj Party (BSP).
- **Unrecognized Parties:** Registered but lack substantial presence or electoral success.

Conditions for Recognition as a State Party

A political party is recognized as a state party in a particular state if it meets any of the following conditions:

1. **Secures 6% of Valid Votes and Wins Seats**: The party must secure **6% of the valid votes** in the state during a general election to the **Legislative Assembly**, and in addition, **win 2 seats** in the state assembly.
2. **Secures 6% of Votes in Lok Sabha**: The party must secure **6% of valid votes** in the state during a general election to the **Lok Sabha**, and additionally, **win 1 seat** in the Lok Sabha from the state.
3. **Percentage of Seats in Legislative Assembly**: The party must win at least **3% of the total seats** in the **Legislative Assembly** or a minimum of **3 seats** in the assembly, whichever is greater.

4. **Lok Sabha Seat Requirement**: The party must win at least **1 seat in the Lok Sabha** for every **25 seats** (or a fraction thereof) allocated to the state in a general election.

5. **Secures 8% of Votes**: The party must secure at least **8% of the total valid votes** in the state during a **General Election** to the **Lok Sabha** or **Legislative Assembly**. This condition was added in **2011**.

Conditions for Recognition as a National Party

A political party is recognized as a national party if it fulfills any of the following criteria:

1. **Secures 6% of Valid Votes**: The party must secure at least **6% of valid votes** in four or more states during a general election to the **Lok Sabha** or **Legislative Assemblies**, and additionally, **win 4 seats in the Lok Sabha** from any state or states.

2. **Seats in Lok Sabha**: The party must win at least **2% of seats in the Lok Sabha** during a general election, with candidates elected from **three or more states**.

3. **State Party Recognition**: If the party is already recognized as a **state party** in four or more states.

Functions of Political Parties in India

- **Nominate Candidates:** Political parties nominate candidates for elections, either for legislative or executive positions.
- **Election Campaigns:** They organize campaigns to garner support for their candidates, highlighting issues of national interest.
- **Formulation of Policies:** Political parties issue manifestos detailing their vision and policies for governance.
- **Government Formation:** After elections, parties that secure a majority form the government, and the opposition plays a crucial role in holding the government accountable.
- **Public Opinion:** Political parties educate and inform the public, shaping the nation's political and social views.
- **Mediation Between Public and Government:** They serve as a communication link, transmitting the people's demands to the government.

Formation of Political Parties

Sr. No.	Name of the Party	Year of Formation
1	Indian National Congress (INC)	1885
2	Shiromani Akali Dal (SAD)	1920
3	Communist Party of India (CPI)	1925
4	Jammu & Kashmir National Conference (JKNC)	1939

5	All India Forward Bloc (AIFB)	1939
6	Revolutionary Socialist Party (RSP)	1940
7	Indian Union Muslim League (IUML)	1948
8	Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (DMK)	1949
9	Mizo National Front (MNF)	1961
10	Maharashtrawadi Gomantak Party (MAG)	1963
11	Communist Party of India (Marxist) (CPM)	1964
12	Shiv Sena (SHS)	1966
13	Mizoram People's Conference (MPC)	1972
14	Jharkhand Mukti Morcha (JMM)	1972
15	All India Anna Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (AIADMK)	1972
16	Kerala Congress (M) (KEC (M))	1979
17	Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP)	1980
18	Telugu Desam Party (TDP)	1982
19	Bahujan Samaj Party (BSP)	1984
20	Asom Gana Parishad (AGP)	1985
21	People's Party of Arunachal (PPA)	1987
22	Samajwadi Party (SP)	1992
23	Sikkim Democratic Front (SDF)	1993
24	Rashtriya Lok Dal (RLD)	1996
25	Zoram Nationalist Party (ZNP)	1997
26	Rashtriya Janata Dal (RJD)	1997
27	Biju Janata Dal (BJD)	1997
28	All India Trinamool Congress (AITC)	1998
29	Indian National Lok Dal (INLD)	1998
30	Jammu and Kashmir People's Democratic Party (PDP)	1999
31	Janata Dal (United) (JD (U))	1999
32	Janata Dal (Secular) (JD(S))	1999
33	Nationalist Congress Party (NCP)	1999
34	Lok Jan Shakti Party (LJSP)	2000
35	Telangana Rashtra Samithi (TRS)	2001

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36	Naga People's Front (NPF)	2002
37	All India United Democratic Front (AUDF)	2004
38	Desiya Murpokku Dravidar Kazhagam (DMDK)	2005
39	Maharashtra Navnirman Sena (MNS)	2006
40	Jharkhand Vikas Morcha (Prajatantrik) (JVM - P)	2006
41	Indigenous People's Front of Tripura (IPFT)	2009
42	Yuvajana Sramika Rythu Congress Party (YSRCP)	2011
43	All India N.R. Congress (AINRC)	2011
44	Aam Aadmi Party (AAP)	2012
45	National People's Party (NPP)	2013
46	Rashtriya Lok Samta Party (RLSP)	2013
47	Sikkim Krantikari Morcha (SKM)	2013
48	Goa Forward Party (GFP)	2016
49	Janata Congress Chhattisgarh (JCC)	2016
50	People's Democratic Front (PDF)	2017
51	National Democratic Progressive Party (NDPP)	2018
52	Rashtriya Loktantrik Party (RLP)	2018